

ATTITUDE

How Feelings and Emotions Shape Behavior

Total Time: 30 Minutes

0:00–3:00 | Opening and Core Thesis

“Today’s lesson is about **attitude**.”

“I want to start with one simple statement. This is the foundation for the entire class.”

Pause. Make eye contact.

“**Feelings and emotions shape attitude.**
And attitude drives actions and behaviors.”

“Everything we are going to do today is built on that.”

“Feelings happen first. Attitude forms second. Behavior comes third.”

3:00–5:00 | Define the Terms (Foundation)

“Let’s define what we mean by these words.”

“**Feelings and emotions** are internal reactions.
They happen automatically.”

“You do not decide to feel confused, frustrated, confident, embarrassed, or stressed. It just happens.”

“**Attitude** is the posture you take toward a situation because of how you feel about it.”

“It is the lens you look through.”

“And **actions and behaviors** are what everyone else sees.”

Key anchor line:

“People do not usually react to situations.
They react to how they feel about the situation.”

5:00–7:00 | Set Up the Demonstration

“In a moment, we are going to watch this happen in real time.”

“I need three volunteers.”

(Bring volunteers to the front.)

To the class:

“Your assignment is not to solve the problems.”

“Your assignment is to observe **attitude**.”

“Specifically, watch:

- What emotions show up
- How those emotions shape attitude
- How attitude drives communication, collaboration, and behavior”

Important framing:

“This is not about intelligence or getting the right answer.
It is about what happens emotionally when people are unsure.”

7:00–15:00 | Group Problem-Solving Exercise

Use a different set of volunteers for each question.

To volunteers:

“You are a group. Talk out loud. Work together.”

Question 1

“A bat and a ball cost \$1.10 total. The bat costs \$1.00 more than the ball. How much does the ball cost?”

Question 2

“If it takes 5 machines 5 minutes to make 5 widgets, how long would it take 100 machines to make 100 widgets?”

Question 3

“A patch of lily pads doubles in size every day. If it takes 48 days to cover the lake, on what day is the lake half covered?”

Question 4

“You are near the front of a race and trying to catch the leaders.

You make a strong push and pass the runner who is in second place.

The crowd cheers.

What place are you in now?”

Do not reveal answers.

Thank the volunteers and have them sit.

15:00–20:00 | Observation Debrief

“Let’s talk about what we saw.”

“Not the answers. The attitudes.”

Ask one question at a time:

- “What emotions did you notice?”
- “How did those emotions shape attitude?”
- “What attitudes helped the group?”
- “What attitudes made collaboration harder?”

Reinforce the thesis:

“What you just saw is this principle in action.”

“Feelings and emotions shaped attitude.
Attitude drove actions and behaviors.”

20:00–24:00 | Teaching: Why This Matters

“This matters because attitude acts like a steering wheel.”

“Two people can feel the same emotion and choose a different attitude.”

“One leans in. One shuts down. One gets defensive. One gets curious.”

Important distinction:

“You do not choose your first feeling.”

“You do choose how you respond to it.”

Key line:

“Attitude is where responsibility begins.”

24:00–27:00 | Real-Life Application

“Think about your own life.”

“When you feel:

- Corrected
- Rushed
- Challenged
- Uncertain
- Not in control”

“What attitude usually shows up?”

“And what behaviors follow?”

“Are those behaviors moving you forward, or holding you back?”

27:00–30:00 | Close and Anchor

Slow and deliberate:

“I want to say the foundation one more time.”

**“Feelings and emotions shape attitude.
Attitude drives actions and behaviors.”**

“If you want different behaviors, check your attitude.”

“If you want to change your attitude, start by paying attention to your emotions.”

Closing line:

“Nothing changes until attitude changes.”